

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-03T20:18:41+00:00

GPT?6 Astra GPT-6 Astra is "rolling out today to a limited set of organizations and over the coming days will become available to all ChatGPT Plus, Pro, Business, and Enterprise users, as well as through the OpenAI API and AWS" - I've not tried it yet myself, so I don't have a great deal to say about it yet. It's going to be API priced at the same rate as Claude Fable 5 and 5.1: \$10/million input and \$50/million output. This is clearly OpenAI's Fable competitor, and appears to score higher than Fable on most of OpenAI's self-reported benchmarks. Most impressively, Astra scores 99.9% on the recent (released in March) ARC-AGI 3 benchmark - though notably Fable 5 does not yet have a published result, and the ARC-AGI blog notes that the 99.9% score was achieved for \$19K using OpenAI's custom "Provider Adapter harness", while the default ARC-AGI harness scored 62.7% for \$26K. The Provider Adapter harness preserves opaque reasoning state between requests and uses compaction for longer conversations, allowing the model to reuse prior work. Unsurprisingly, given the recent Hugging Face incident , Astra is a beast at security tasks. It scores 100% on ExploitBench (GPT-5.6 Sol got 78.5%), 4...

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-01T17:01:11+00:00

They took the letters from me! I have to talk about dwarf behavior now. I can't even talk about dwarf AI. It doesn't exist. It's dwarf behavior , and they misbehave sometimes ? Tarn Adams , co-creator of Dwarf Fortress Tags: ai , game-design

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-01T15:30:12+00:00

Release: datasette-mcp 0.2 "rows" from `execute_sql` is now an array of objects. Previously it was an array of arrays. This should help weaker models avoid losing track of which positional array element maps to which column. #1 Now depends on `mcp` $\geq 2.1.1$. This is the first non-alpha release of the plugin. I'm confident it's ready as I've been using it quite a bit myself. Tags: `datasette`, `model-context-protocol`

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-04T01:35:24Z

Simon Willison: GPT-6 Astra is ?rolling out today to a limited set of organizations and over the coming days will become available to all ChatGPT Plus, Pro, Business, and Enterprise users, as well as through the OpenAI API and AWS? ? I?ve not tried it yet myself, so I don?t have a great deal to say about it yet. It?s going to be API priced at the same rate as Claude Fable 5 and 5.1: \$10/million input and \$50/million output. This is clearly OpenAI?s Fable competitor, and appears to score higher than Fable on most of OpenAI?s self-reported benchmarks. ?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-03T16:39:09Z

running-app-store-and-product-events?accessToken=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJzb2VyYy
2UiOiJTdWJzY3JpYmVvR2lmdGVkQXJ0aWNsZSIsImhhdCI6MTc0ODE5Mzk5NywiZXhwIjoxNzg4Nzk4Nzk3LCJhcncpY2xi
SWQiOiJUS0VDTE1LSkg2VjQwMCIsImJjb25uZWNOZWQ0FFMUZBMDU0MEJFQTl0QTIGMjExQzFFOTA4MC.
fAbZOZH31AOBLUaiPYPUJ7BgRvelUN7SbxOZFAgMXE

Mark Gurman: Apple Inc.'s Phil Schiller, one of the most visible and influential executives across both the Steve Jobs and Tim Cook eras, has stepped down from his role leading the App

Store and product events. The 66-year-old executive, who was Apple's senior vice president of marketing until leaving that job in 2020, made the latest change in recent days, according to people with knowledge of the matter. This is true, I've confirmed. Seems natural for this to coincide with the CEO transition. What a run for Schiller. ?

6. MapQuest Refuses to Relabel Lake Ontario, Rewarded With Surge in Popularity

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-03T16:30:09Z

Link: <https://thehill.com/homenews/administration/6063924-mapquest-tops-apple-google-maps-in-downloads-after-refusing-trumps-lake-america-change/?ref=ihnatko.com>

Finya Swai, reporting for The Hill two days ago: MapQuest has surged in popularity on the app charts after the mapping service said it would not rename Lake Ontario to 'Lake America' after President Trump signed an executive order changing its name. The company said its mobile app received hundreds of thousands of downloads after it announced Thursday that the name Lake Ontario would remain on its apps, despite Trump directing the Interior Department to update the lake's name in the Geographic Names Information System (GNIS). By Monday morning, MapQuest had climbed to No. 1 among navigation apps in Apple's U.S. app store and No. 4 in non-gaming apps. In Canada, which shares the lake with the U.S., the app reached No. 2 overall over the weekend. The app's usage also jumped to roughly 50 times its normal level, according to MapQuest. Here we are on Thursday and MapQuest still holds the #1 spot, ahead of ChatGPT, Vinted (never heard of it), 'TikTok Pro - Events' (a confusing new app, apart from the main TikTok client), ESPN Fantasy Sports (the NFL season is about to start), Claude, and Gemini. When opportunity knocks, you need to open the door. The political corner that both Apple a...

7. The case of the progress callback that never got called when progress happened

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260903-00/?p=112672>

Are you talking to the right guy? The post The case of the progress callback that never got called when progress happened appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Hugging Face Easter Egg

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 23:34:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/03/hugging-face-easter-egg/>

NVIDIA has offered to buy Hugging Face for \$12,930,300,000. 129303 is the Unicode code point for the Hugging Face emoji (U+1F917), which you can verify with the following Python code. >>> import unicodedata >>> 129303 == 0x1F917 True >>> unicodedata.name(chr(0x1F917)) 'HUGGING FACE' Related posts Prevent characters from displaying as emoji Unicode, Tolkien, and Privacy Unicode [?] The post Hugging Face Easter Egg first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. New RSA number factored

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 17:21:45 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/03/new-rsa-number-factored/>

Eric Lu announced on X today that he has factored RSA-260, a number N with 260 digits (862 bits) that is the product of two large primes [1]. RSA numbers are challenge problems posed to gauge the security of RSA encryption, which rests on the difficulty of factoring large numbers [2]. The naming scheme is [?] The post New RSA number factored first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. How Will the 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act Affect Housing Supply? Part III

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 19:20:13 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-will-the-21st-century-road-to-21c>

This is my third and final essay looking at the 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act, and how it's likely to affect housing supply.

11. Putting my JAX-trained models on the Hugging Face Hub

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 18:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilestomas.com/2026/09/jax-models-on-hugging-face>

I hadn't uploaded the models that I trained using JAX to the Hugging Face Hub because Transformers has been PyTorch-only since version 5 (though they say they're working to add interoperability with JAX in the future), so it would have been tough to get them working natively with AutoModelForCausalLM and the like. But then it dawned on me that I'd already written a conversion script that could take my JAX safetensors files and convert them into ones compatible with my PyTorch code. It's actually those converted models that I use for my evals -- so I could use my existing PyTorch script to upload them. So, I've now uploaded PyTorch-compatible versions of all of my JAX-trained models: " Writing an LLM from scratch, part 34b -- from bigrams to GPT-2, one component at a time (in JAX) " gpjt/jax-no-mha-bias-no-dropout -- the first full LLM trained in the post, in the "Adding LayerNorm" section. gpjt/jax-no-mha-bias-with-dropout -- the second full LLM trained in the post, in the "Dropout" section. gpjt/jax-with-mha-bias-no-dropout -- the third full LLM trained in the post, in the "Adding bias to the MHA output projections" section. " Why do OpenAI's GPT-2 weights beat mine? Part three:...

12. Can We Stop With the Uptime Percentages?

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/stop-with-the-uptime-percentage/>

I was reading Jason Gorman's article "The Wall Confronting Reliable Coding Agent Autonomy" and he says: the journey from 90% to 99% reliability is just as hard as it was to get to 90%. And from 99% to 99.9% is just as hard again. This stood out, as I've been experiencing more and more "downtime" in my day-to-day work. GitHub's down. CI's down. AI's down. Slack's down. Downtime's going mainstream! More and more I find myself visiting service status pages, where I'm confronted with a wall of colors and numbers like this: 100%? 99.72%? 99.09%? 98.98%? Those don't all seem so different or bad? I mean, those are all an A in grade school. Then I have to remind myself of Jason's point and re-interpret the numbers, which is more like reading earthquake measurements. The difference between a 6.2 and a 7.8 might not seem that big, but it represents a massive difference in magnitude. Uptime percentages have a similar problem: 99.9% and 99.99% look pretty much the same, but the latter is 10×less! Infrastructure people understand this. They even have a shorthand for it: two nines, three nines, four nines. They intuitively grasp the difference because they swim in these numbers every day. Bu...

13. simple is not small

Source: the website of jyn | Published: 2026-08-27T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://jyn.dev/simple-is-not-the-same-as-small/>

small programs hide coupling

14. Pluralistic: Preparing for a post-Trump internet (03 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 08:45:19 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/03/broken-arrows/>

Today's links Preparing for a post-Trump internet: You'd better hope it's also a post-American internet. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Barnum and Bailey v journalism; Wired's Wikipedia article is a wiki; Singapore's national wifi; Twitter arguments. Upcoming appearances: D?browa Góńicza, Warsaw, Brighton, London, Budapest, Edmonton, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Preparing for a post-Trump internet (permalink) What if post-Trump America is even worse? I know, it's tempting to think of Trump as a cause, rather than an effect ? as an aberration who dragged America into fascism. Trump is exceptional, but the thing that makes him exceptional isn't his corruption, recklessness or cruelty. What makes Trump exceptional is his ability to cajole, intimidate and flatter America's most corrupt, reckless and cruel people into a coalition. These people hate each other. Nick Fuentes drifts off to sleep every night furiously fantasizing about turning Stephen Mi...

15. De nieuwe AIVD/MIVD wet: een eerste overzicht

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 13:20:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/de-wiv-202x/>

In mijn vorige artikel schreef ik hoeveel de AIVD en MIVD nu al mogen. Inmiddels is het nieuwe wetsvoorstel gepubliceerd, en wat blijkt, men wil nog veel ruimere bevoegdheden, met veel minder toezicht. Ik heb veel vragen gekregen wat nou het ergste is aan de nieuwe wet, maar het is in z'n geheel een totale uitholling van de rechtsstaat door diensten die zijn losgezongen van de maatschappij en zelden of nooit naar zichzelf kijken als de resultaten tegenvallen.

16. You Should be Using Rootless Containers

Source: Miguel Grinberg's Blog | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 14:59:54 GMT

Link: <https://blog.miguelgrinberg.com/post/you-should-be-using-rootless-containers>

The other day a serious vulnerability was disclosed in one of the newer Linux distributions (the one led by the racist, so it isn't getting a mention here). The issue was interesting because it was caused by a non-standard Docker configuration that their installer applied by default, without alerting users that this configuration was creating a security risk. The end result was that any process running on these systems had the ability to elevate itself to root, without password, sudo or any prompts to the user. While this incident did not affect me, it served as a reminder that it is difficult to set up Docker in a way that is secure. If you are interested in understanding what the issues with Docker are and what can be done to address them, then you are in the right place.

17. A reasonably practical guide to validating RFC 9421 HTTP Signatures for ActivityPub in PHP

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 03 Sep 2026 11:34:12 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/a-reasonably-practical-guide-to-validating-rfc-9421-http-signatures-for-activitypub-in-php/>

If you're reading this, you've probably been hitting your head against a brick wall trying to parse and decipher the new HTTP Signatures sent by Mastodon and other Fediverse servers. This is a basic and somewhat incomplete guide to accepting these signatures. I'm sure there are various gotchas, but it works with the signatures I've seen in the wild. Shut Up And Show Me The Code! OK, wow, no?